

Digital Innovation Center Website

UI/UX Design Plan

Document	UI/UX DESIGN PLAN
Version	1.0
Prepared for	Startup Jigawa Ltd
Date	20 September 2026

Brand basis: Deep Green #265728, Black #000000, Off-white #F7F7F7, White #FFFFFF.

Source basis: Startup Jigawa Ltd Company Profile, 2026. Product and technical recommendations in this document are proposed specifications unless explicitly stated as source-derived institutional facts.

Document Purpose

This plan defines the visual direction, interaction principles, information hierarchy, responsive behavior, component system and page-level UX approach for the Startup Jigawa Digital Innovation Center Website. It is intended to prevent a generic “tech startup template” outcome and create a design that feels institutional, local, credible and easy to use.

Primary design direction

Minimal institutional design. Strong typography. Real Startup Jigawa photography. Generous whitespace. Clear evidence and status presentation. Green used deliberately, not everywhere. Motion should support orientation, never become the visual identity.

1. Brand Foundation

1.1 Primary Color Palette

Token	Hex	Role
Brand Green	#265728	Primary CTA, active states, small emphasis, icon accents, selected UI.
Black	#000000	High-contrast headings, navigation emphasis and key statistics.
Off White	#F7F7F7	Primary soft background and section separation.
White	#FFFFFF	Cards, content surfaces and clean page backgrounds.

The primary green is derived from the supplied Startup Jigawa brand reference image. The interface should not become a full green canvas. Use white/off-white as the dominant surface and reserve green for intentional brand and interaction emphasis.

1.2 Supporting Neutrals and Functional Colors

Purpose	Suggested token	Notes
Primary text	#111111	Near-black for long-form readability; pure black for strong headings only.
Secondary text	#5C5C5C	Metadata and supporting copy.
Border	#DADADA	Subtle separators and card boundaries.
Green tint	#EAF2EA	Soft branded background, selected state or callout.
Success	Accessible green distinct enough from brand when needed	Use icon/text plus color.
Warning	Accessible amber	Deadlines, attention and review status.
Error	Accessible red	Validation/destructive states; never

Purpose	Suggested token	Notes
		brand decoration.

2. Visual Personality

The website should feel like a credible Northern Nigerian innovation and development institution, not an agency landing page and not a youth bootcamp template. Its visual language should be confident and contemporary while allowing institutional documents, partner logos, program photography and data to remain the focus.

Use more	Use less / avoid
Real program and community photography	Generic AI illustrations or random 3D blobs.
Strong editorial typography	Multiple decorative fonts.
Whitespace and clear grids	Dense card walls.
Fine borders and restrained shadows	Heavy floating/glassmorphism panels.
Simple iconography	Mixing multiple icon styles.
Purposeful data visuals	Decorative charts with no evidence.
Subtle transitions	Continuous parallax and excessive scroll animation.
Specific program/status labels	Vague “innovate/empower/disrupt” copy without context.

3. Typography

Recommended web pairing: Manrope for display/headings and Inter for body/UI, both with robust system fallbacks. If the team prefers a single family, Inter can handle the entire interface. Typography should feel modern but highly readable on low-cost mobile screens.

Style	Desktop guidance	Mobile guidance
Hero display	48-64 px, 1.00-1.08 line height	36-44 px, 1.05-1.12 line height
H1 page title	40-48 px	32-38 px
H2	28-34 px	24-30 px
H3	20-24 px	19-22 px
Body large	18-20 px	17-18 px
Body	16 px	16 px
Small/meta	13-14 px	13-14 px

Avoid extra-light weights. Use medium/bold sparingly to create hierarchy. Body copy should remain comfortable at 16 px minimum for public content.

4. Layout System

Area	Guidance
Max content width	Approx. 1200-1280 px for standard institutional pages.
Reading width	Approx. 680-780 px for long-form articles/research descriptions.
Grid	12-column desktop, 8-column tablet, 4-column mobile.
Page padding	Desktop 48-72 px; tablet 32 px; mobile 18-24 px.
Section spacing	80-120 px desktop; 56-80 px mobile depending on density.
Radius	8-14 px; avoid overly rounded “app bubble” styling.
Shadow	Very subtle; prefer border + surface contrast.
Borders	1 px neutral; green only for selected/highlighted states.

5. Navigation UX

5.1 Desktop Header

- Left: Startup Jigawa logo/wordmark.
- Center/right: concise primary navigation.
- High-emphasis CTA: Apply / Get Involved.
- Search available without dominating the header.
- Sticky behavior may activate after initial scroll, with reduced vertical height.

5.2 Mobile Header

- Logo and menu button visible in one compact row.
- Menu opens as a full-height or large sheet with grouped navigation.
- Apply / Get Involved CTA remains visible inside menu and optionally as a compact header action.
- No hover-dependent interactions.
- Large tap targets (minimum ~44 px) and clear focus states.

6. Homepage Experience Plan

Section	UX intent	Design treatment
Hero	Explain institution and offer immediate routes.	Large editorial headline, 2 CTAs, real photography or one restrained visual composition.
Impact strip	Build credibility quickly.	4 concise metrics with source/period tooltips or links where useful.
What we do	Orient users to capabilities.	4-8 concise links, not long marketing cards.
Programs / opportunities	Drive action.	Status-forward cards with deadline,

Section	UX intent	Design treatment
		audience/location and one clear CTA.
Innovation Labs	Explain portfolio architecture.	Four numbered/structured panels or horizontal editorial blocks.
Sectors	Show breadth without clutter.	Five simple sector links with brief outcome-oriented descriptions.
How we work	Show methodology.	Responsive pathway timeline; horizontal on desktop, vertical on mobile.
Impact story/product	Provide evidence.	Image + result + context; avoid unsupported “success” claims.
Partners	Strengthen trust.	Consistent monochrome/approved logos; no logo wall overload.
News/events	Show freshness.	2-4 latest items with date/status.
Closing CTA	Convert interest.	Partner, apply, collaborate or contact choices.

7. Low-Fidelity Homepage Wireframe

HEADER | Logo | Navigation | Search | Apply / Get Involved

HERO | Headline + institutional description + 2 CTAs + real image

IMPACT | 9 Years | 50,000+ Trained | 12+ Partners | 5 Sectors

WHAT WE DO | Talent | Entrepreneurship | Technology | Civic Tech | Research | Inclusion

FEATURED OPPORTUNITIES | Open / upcoming program cards with visible deadlines

INNOVATION LABS | 4 lab portfolio blocks

SECTORS | AgriTech | HealthTech | EduTech | GovTech | Digital Commerce

HOW WE WORK | Community Listening -> Evidence -> Design -> Pilot -> Evaluate -> Scale

FEATURED IMPACT STORY | Photo + problem + intervention + verified result

PARTNERS + NEWS | Approved partner logos + latest updates

FOOTER | Institutional links | Opportunities | Resources | Legal | Contact

8. Core Component System

Component	Design requirement
Buttons	Primary green, secondary outline/dark, tertiary text link; small/medium/large; loading/disabled states.
Links	Visible underline or directional cue in body; not green-only distinction.
Program card	Status, title, short summary, audience/location, deadline/date and CTA.
Opportunity card	Deadline/status emphasized; avoid hidden eligibility details.
News card	Image optional, category, date, title and short excerpt.
Publication card	Type, title, date, authors/source and Download/View action.
Partner logo item	Fixed logo area with accessible name; avoid distortion.
Impact metric	Value, label, reporting period/source context where relevant.
Status badge	Open, Closed, Ongoing, Pilot, Live etc.; icon/text + color.
Breadcrumb	All deep detail pages.
Filter bar	Search + category/status chips/dropdowns; collapsible on mobile.
Accordion	FAQs, curriculum details, eligibility or long secondary information.
Callout	Important deadlines, verification context, application notices.
Form controls	Inputs, selects, textarea, upload, checkbox/radio with persistent labels.
Modal/dialog	Use sparingly for confirmations, not primary content.
Toast/alert	Accessible success/error feedback for form/admin actions.

9. Program and Opportunity UX

These pages are high-conversion areas. Deadline, status and eligibility must appear before long narrative copy.

Page zone	Content
Top	Breadcrumb, status, program/opportunity title, short summary.
Action panel	Application state, deadline, dates, location/mode, audience, CTA.
Overview	Problem/purpose, objectives and expected outcomes.
Eligibility	Who should apply, prerequisites, required documents.
Delivery	Schedule, location, format and facilitators where public.
Partners	Approved partner information.
FAQs / notes	Clarifications and safeguarding/privacy information.

Page zone	Content
Related	Relevant programs, news, events or impact stories.

Closed-state behavior

Do not remove the page when applications close. Replace the primary CTA with a clear “Applications Closed” state and, when appropriate, offer “View other opportunities” or newsletter subscription.

10. Innovation and Product UX

Product pages should tell a problem-to-solution story rather than imitate commercial SaaS landing pages unless the product itself has a separate marketing site. The institutional site should clarify the problem, target users, approach, current status and evidence.

- Show lifecycle status visibly but neutrally (Concept, Prototype, Pilot, Live, etc.).
- Use screenshots only when current and representative.
- Keep technology stack secondary to user problem and outcomes.
- Link to external product site only if approved and available.
- Avoid fake user counts, testimonials or “trusted by” claims.

11. Impact UX

Impact should look like evidence, not decoration. Every prominent figure should have context such as period, source, program or verification note.

Pattern	Use
Metric cards	Top-level verified figures only.
Trend chart	Use only when multiple comparable periods exist.
Impact story	Problem -> intervention -> result -> evidence/partner.
Report download	Link deeper claims to annual/impact reports where available.
Source detail	Tooltip, footnote or “How we measure” page for methodology.

12. Research & Publication UX

- Searchable/filterable library with clear content type and publication date.
- Display file type/size where useful before download.
- Provide a readable summary before the download action.
- Use stable URLs for citation/sharing.
- Offer related research, sector or program links rather than infinite scrolling.

13. About and Institutional Credibility Pages

The About area should use an editorial, evidence-forward structure. Avoid turning every subsection into a separate card.

- Our Story: timeline from 2017 with only verified milestones.
- Vision, Mission & Values: concise, highly readable presentation.
- Leadership: consistent headshots, name, role, short bio and approved professional links.
- Governance: simplified organogram/functional structure with downloadable policy links where approved.
- Our Approach: Community-to-Policy pathway as the primary visual explainer.
- Facilities: real images and verified capacity details when available.

14. Community-to-Policy Visual

The profile’s delivery pathway is a strong differentiator and should become a reusable responsive component. Desktop can use a horizontal or stepped timeline; mobile should use a vertical sequence.

Step	Short UI label
1	Listen
2	Document
3	Collect Data
4	Analyse
5	Validate
6	Design
7	Prototype / Intervene
8	Pilot
9	Evaluate
10	Scale / Dialogue

Institutional source references: Company Profile section 22.

15. Responsive Behavior

Breakpoint context	Behavior
Large desktop	Full navigation, multi-column editorial layouts, 3-4 item card rows where content length allows.
Laptop / tablet landscape	Reduce columns and whitespace; preserve information hierarchy.
Tablet portrait	2-column cards, compact header, simplified timelines.
Mobile	Single-column reading; filter drawers; vertical timelines; sticky action only where it does not obscure content.

Responsive design should be content-led rather than merely shrinking desktop. Long titles, Hausa/English content and real partner/program names must be tested for wrapping.

16. Accessibility UX

- Text contrast meets WCAG AA; brand green must be tested with each text/background pairing.
- Keyboard focus is always visible.
- All interactive controls have text labels or accessible names.
- Form errors appear next to fields and in an accessible summary for long forms.
- Images include useful alt text; decorative images use empty alt.
- Motion reduces when the operating system requests reduced motion.
- Status is communicated with words/icons, not only color.
- Tap targets are comfortably sized for mobile use.

17. Motion and Interaction

Use	Guidance
Page reveal	Minimal fade/translate for selected sections; content should not wait on animation.
Hover	Small color/border/icon movement on desktop only.
Counters	Optional restrained count-up once; show final value without JS dependency.
Timeline	Progressive highlight on scroll optional; vertical content remains readable without it.
Navigation	Fast, predictable menu transitions.
Do not use	Constant floating objects, heavy parallax, cursor effects, long intro animations, motion-only status.

18. Imagery Direction

Photography should communicate real people, places and delivery. Prefer original Startup Jigawa images from training, field/community activities, product work, partnerships and events. Use consent and safeguarding rules, especially for children and vulnerable participants.

- Avoid repetitive staged laptop photos and generic “African tech” stock imagery.
- Use consistent crop ratios for cards, but allow editorial full-width images in stories.
- Do not over-process images with strong green overlays; preserve natural documentary credibility.
- Add captions and credits when context matters.
- For partner logos, preserve brand rules and clear space.

19. Forms UX

- Persistent labels; placeholders are supplementary, not labels.

- Group long applications into logical sections with progress indicator.
- Save draft only if scope justifies the account/session complexity; otherwise keep Phase 1 forms concise.
- Explain required documents before file upload fields.
- Show accepted file types and maximum size.
- Provide clear consent and privacy notice before submit.
- After submit, show reference/confirmation and next-step expectation.
- Do not clear user input after a recoverable validation error.

20. Search and Filter UX

Search should help users find actionable content quickly. On listing pages, filters should reflect user decisions rather than internal organizational taxonomy.

Listing	Useful filters
Opportunities	Status, type, audience, location, closing date.
Programs	Category/pillar, audience, delivery mode, status.
Publications	Type, sector/topic, year.
News	Category, year.
Events	Upcoming/past, type, delivery mode.

21. Admin UI/UX Plan

The admin should favor operational clarity over visual similarity to the public site. Use the brand colors lightly while prioritizing tables, filters, status, evidence fields and role-aware actions.

- Dashboard: upcoming deadlines, drafts awaiting review, recent submissions and quick actions.
- List screens: search, filters, status chips, bulk-safe operations and visible last-updated data.
- Edit screens: clear sections, autosave only if reliable, explicit publish/review state.
- Impact fields: source and verification controls adjacent to the metric, not hidden in advanced settings.
- Partner fields: clearly distinguish internal relationship status from public description.
- Destructive actions: confirmation with entity name; permission-gated.
- Audit history: readable timeline for sensitive entities where useful.

22. Content Style Guidelines

Rule	Example behavior
Lead with specifics	“Applications open for...” before institutional background.
Use plain language	Explain GovTech/civic tech where audience may not know the terms.
Keep dates explicit	Use “19 September 2026” rather than ambiguous numeric

Rule	Example behavior
	dates.
Distinguish status	“In design”, “Pilot”, “Live”, “Completed” must mean different things.
Avoid unsupported superlatives	Do not use “leading”, “largest”, “best” unless approved and supportable.
Local relevance	Allow English/Hausa friendly content structure without forcing translations in Phase 1.

23. Design Deliverables

- Sitemap and user-flow diagrams.
- Low-fidelity wireframes for all core templates.
- High-fidelity responsive designs for desktop and mobile.
- Design tokens: colors, typography, spacing, radius, elevation and motion.
- Reusable component library with states and accessibility notes.
- Homepage, listing and detail templates for programs/opportunities, research, news/events, products, sectors and impact.
- Admin UX for dashboard, content lists, edit forms, applications and verification flows.
- Prototype for critical user journeys.
- Developer handoff with behavior, responsive rules and content constraints.

24. Design QA Checklist

Area	Acceptance
Brand	Green #265728, black and white/off-white form the dominant identity; no competing decorative palette.
Hierarchy	Every page has one clear primary purpose and CTA hierarchy.
Mobile	No overflow, clipped controls or desktop-only hover dependence.
Content	Realistic long titles, dates, partner names and status labels tested.
Accessibility	Contrast, keyboard/focus, labels and reduced motion reviewed.
Performance	Design does not require heavy hero video, oversized image galleries or excessive animation.
Credibility	No unverified testimonials, impact figures, partner relationships or product states in mockups.
Consistency	Components use common spacing, radius, type and status patterns across templates.

25. Page Template Inventory

Template	Primary purpose
Homepage	Institutional orientation and conversion.
Standard content page	About, vision/mission, governance and policy information.
Programs listing	Discover programs by category/audience/status.
Program detail	Understand and apply.
Opportunities listing	Find currently actionable opportunities.
Innovation Lab	Explain lab purpose, initiatives, products and evidence.
Product detail	Problem, solution, status, users and evidence.
Sector page	Sector capability, beneficiaries, programs/products/research.
Impact overview	Verified metrics, stories and methodology.
Impact story	Narrative evidence and outcomes.
Research library	Search/filter/download knowledge products.
Publication detail	Summary, metadata and download.
News listing / article	Current institutional communication.
Events listing / detail	Discover and register for events.
Partners	Partner categories and engagement pathway.
Contact	Route enquiries appropriately.
Search results	Cross-site discovery.
404 / empty state	Recover users with helpful routes, not dead ends.

Appendix A - Brand Usage Summary

Primary brand colors for the website are Deep Green #265728, Black #000000, Off White #F7F7F7 and White #FFFFFF. Recommended surface balance is predominantly white/off-white, with black/dark typography and green used as a controlled accent and interaction color. Functional colors may be introduced for success, warning and error states but must remain secondary to the institutional palette.